SITGURU OPERATING POLICY

Communications & Messaging Policy and User Guide

For the Social Media & Community Growth Manager, interns, authorized team members, and community-facing work

Core rule: Use SitGuru Messaging for day-to-day operational and community communication. Use the system of record for the work itself: Planner for tasks, Growth Workspace for outcomes, Intern Portal for academic records, Timekeeper for official time, and SharePoint for official files.

1. Purpose and Scope

SitGuru Messaging is the primary company-controlled messaging environment for routine internal operational communication and authorized communication with the SitGuru community. This policy applies to the Growth Manager, interns, future staff, and other authorized users. It covers internal conversations, community conversations, shared-inbox work, internal notes, reporting, moderation, and professional communication standards.

2. Where Communication Belongs

Need	Primary system
Quick internal operational message	SitGuru Messaging
Ava to intern coaching / day-to-day coordination	SitGuru Messaging
Authorized Pet Parent, Guru, Ambassador or Partner conversation	SitGuru Messaging
Internal note about a community conversation	SitGuru Messaging - Internal Note
Task, owner, deadline or workflow stage	Microsoft Planner
Meeting, video call, screen share or collaborative working session	Microsoft Teams
Official shared team document	SharePoint
Formal external email / university coordination	Outlook

Need	Primary system
Growth result, campaign, event, experiment, KPI or learning	SitGuru Growth Workspace
Internship academic record, weekly report, milestone or final-project evidence	SitGuru Intern Portal
Official hours and approvals	SitGuru Timekeeper when enabled

3. Internal SitGuru Messaging

Use internal messaging for routine company communication such as quick questions, coaching, coordination, status clarification, and decisions that do not require a separate formal record. Internal conversations may include Founder to Growth Manager, Growth Manager to assigned interns, authorized intern collaboration, and approved team/group threads.

- Important decisions that change scope, deadlines, approvals, or ownership should also be reflected in the appropriate system of record rather than living only in chat.

4. Community Messaging

The Growth Manager may communicate in an official SitGuru capacity with authorized Pet Parents, Gurus, Ambassadors, Partners, and other approved community contacts. The system should clearly identify the SitGuru team member and their role. Community members should never have to guess whether they are talking with an ordinary marketplace user or an authorized SitGuru representative.

- Official identity for Ava: Ava Venezia - Social Media & Community Growth Manager - SitGuru - ava@sitguru.com.
- Interns should use an approved team identity such as “[Name] - SitGuru Community Growth Team” and only the audiences/permissions assigned to them.

5. Internal Notes vs. Messages to the Community

Type	Visible to	Use
Message to community member	External participant + authorized SitGuru participants	Customer/community-facing response, outreach, follow-up or assistance.
Internal Note	Authorized SitGuru team only	Coaching, assignment context, escalation notes, handoff information, or internal discussion that must never be exposed externally.

Safety rule: Never place confidential HR/personnel, tax, banking, passwords, API keys, payment-card data, or other restricted records into ordinary messaging. Use the approved secure repository/workflow.

6. Intern Messaging Permissions

Intern community-messaging authority is earned and configurable. Interns do not receive unrestricted outbound messaging merely because they are interns.

Level	Typical use	Manager expectation
Directed / Review Required	Early onboarding or higher-risk work. Intern may draft or reply only to assigned conversations.	Ava reviews before send and coaches tone, accuracy, authority, and privacy.
Guided	Intern responds within approved audiences/guardrails; selected message types still require review.	Ava spot-checks, coaches exceptions, and expands autonomy when judgment is demonstrated.
Independent Within Guardrails	Later-stage intern handles approved routine conversations independently.	Ava monitors workload/outcomes and steps in for escalations, risk, or performance concerns.

7. Professional Communication Standards

- Be clear, respectful, helpful, and professional. Assume written messages may be retained and reviewed.
- Use SitGuru-approved channels for assigned work. Do not shift official outreach to personal text, personal email, WhatsApp, personal social DMs, or another private channel unless specifically approved.
- Do not promise refunds, compensation, legal outcomes, contractual terms, employment decisions, partnership commitments, or policy exceptions without the authority to do so.
- Do not overstate SitGuru capabilities, availability, safety, verification, results, or guarantees.
- Protect confidential information and use only the information necessary to complete the task.
- When a conversation becomes sensitive, threatening, discriminatory, sexually inappropriate, fraudulent, or otherwise concerning, stop routine handling and use the report/escalation process.

8. Reporting, Blocking and Escalation

Users should be able to report a message or conversation for concerns such as harassment, bullying, threatening language, discrimination, sexual/inappropriate content, spam/scam activity, confidential information, credentials/sensitive data, off-platform payment requests, safety concerns, or other workplace/community concerns.

- If an intern reports a concern involving their direct manager, the issue should route to Founder/Admin or another authorized reviewer rather than depending on the manager named in the report.
- Serious safety, security, legal, privacy, credential, financial-fraud, or harassment concerns should be escalated promptly to Founder/Admin.

9. Monitoring, Retention and Audit Notice

SitGuru messaging systems are provided for authorized business and internship communication. Communications made through company systems may be retained, logged, reviewed, or audited by specifically authorized SitGuru administrators for legitimate operational, security, safety, professional-conduct, compliance, investigation, trust-and-safety, or legal purposes, subject to applicable law and company policy.

- Users should not use SitGuru company messaging for personal communications they expect to remain private. Administrative access should follow least privilege and should itself be auditable.
- Edits/deletions should not silently rewrite history where preservation is required. Flagged or investigation-related records may be preserved according to applicable policy.

10. Ava's Manager Responsibilities

- Use SitGuru Messaging as the normal operational communication channel for Growth Team work.
- Assign or adjust intern messaging permissions based on development, assignment needs, and demonstrated judgment.
- Review early-stage or higher-risk intern outreach when required, then increase autonomy as appropriate.
- Use Internal Notes for team-only context in community conversations.
- Escalate significant conduct, safety, security, legal, policy, or reputational issues to Founder/Admin.
- Keep task ownership, official approvals, academic records, and time records in their designated systems instead of treating chat as the source of truth.

11. Before You Send

Check	Question
Identity	Am I speaking in the correct SitGuru role/account?
Audience	Is this person/audience within my messaging permissions?
Authority	Am I making a promise or commitment I am authorized to make?

Check	Question
Privacy	Am I sharing only the minimum necessary information?
Tone	Would I be comfortable with this message being reviewed later?
Record	Does a task/approval/result/time record also need to be updated elsewhere?
Escalation	Is there anything here that should be reported, blocked, or escalated instead of answered routinely?

Policy owner: Founder / authorized SitGuru administration. Material changes may require re-acknowledgment through the onboarding/policy workflow.